Symptoms of Vitamin E deficiency

- Anaemia in premature infants.
- Increased risk of oxidative damage to body tissues.
- Vitamin E deficiency may lead to heart and lung disease and brain stroke.
- Frequent blood clots may occur which in turn play a role in the production of varicose veins.

11.2.4 Vitamin K

Vitamin K is called "coagulation vitamin". It is essential for the production of a type of protein called prothrombin and other factors involved in the blood-clotting mechanism. Prothrombin levels in the blood determine the rate at which the blood will clot. For blood to clot, fibrinogen a soluble protein must be converted into fibrin. Thrombin catalyses the proteolysis of fibrinogen to yield fibrin.

Functions

- Helps in clotting of blood.
- Participates in bone formation and remodeling (synthesis of osteocalcin).
- It is necessary for the formation of bone matrix and mineral deposition.
- Vitamin K is essential for the prevention of internal bleeding and haemorrhages.
- It is important for the normal functioning of the liver.
- It is involved in energy producing activities of the tissues and nervous system.

Food Sources of Vitamin K

The concentration of vitamin K in foods is highest in dark green leafy vegetables, especially spinach. It is also found in soyabean, yoghurt, wheat, oats, milk, meat,

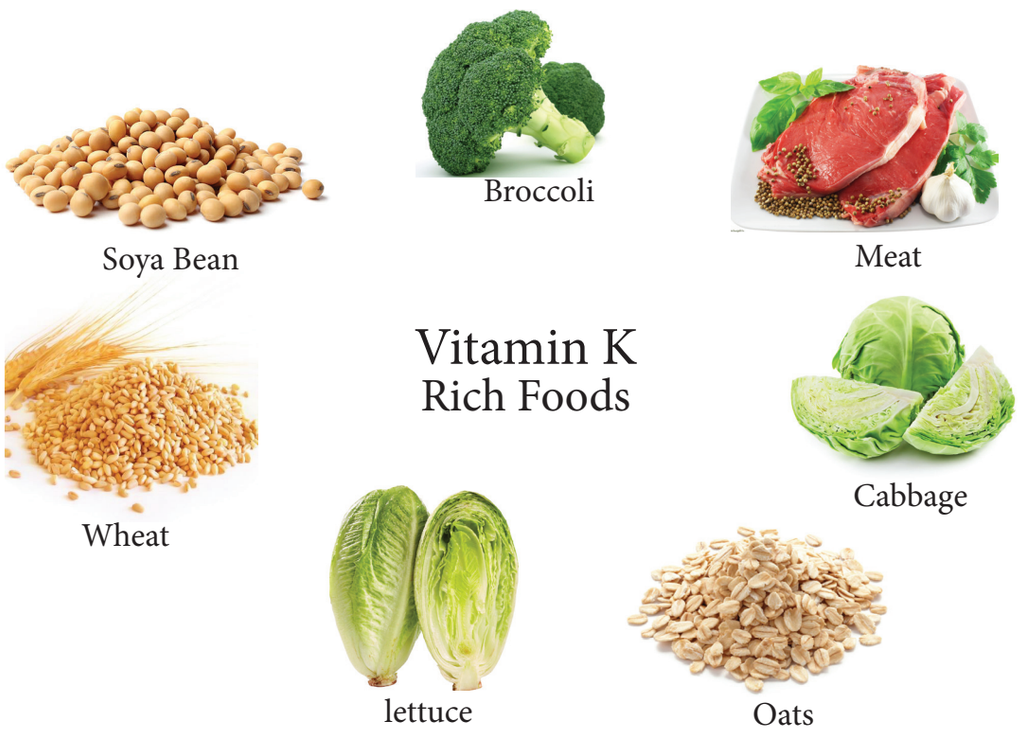


Fig 11.6: Food Sources of Vitamin K

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